



Final Term Wrap Up and Assessment - Happy Holidays and have a great break!

From Dylan Fries <dyfries@rrc.ca>

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To John Carlson <jcarlson33@academic.rrc.ca>; Conor Daly <cdaly3@academic.rrc.ca>; Aiden Desjarlais <adesjarlais31@academic.rrc.ca>; Cole Dorman <cdorman@Academic.RRC.ca>; Dylan Fries <dyfries@rrc.ca>; Russell Paredes <rparedes2@academic.rrc.ca>; Marlena Parenteau <mparenteau@academic.rrc.ca>; SANTIAGO PINTO (he/him) <spinto@Academic.RRC.ca>; Alex Quennelle <aquennelle@academic.rrc.ca>; Cate Runions <crunions2@academic.rrc.ca>; Yuhang Zhang <yuhangzhang@academic.rrc.ca>

Cc Chris Brower <cbrower@rrc.ca>; Kyle Geske <kgeske@rrc.ca>

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Hi Everyone,

I just wanted to send out a final message before you all head off on the break.

First of all, I enjoyed working with you all this semester. We had our ups and downs, some contentious moments, but you are an interesting, technically skilled and creative group and I'm looking forward to working with you next semester and exploring the GS4 project in more detail. You really all have your own unique strengths, and weaknesses, and we will need each and every one of you to be able to be successful next term.

I hope you get a good chance to relax, play some games, reflect on your experience and come back fresh and ready to tackle the next challenges.

Assignments & Grades:

I wanted to let you know that I have posted the final grades and I'm happy to report everyone passed. Next semester is our most ambitious project yet and we will need all of your unique skills and talent if we are going to be able to make it work so I was glad to see everyone made it through.

Also, a 5% reflection document had not been included in the final GD1 grades as I had graded but not published it. I've submitted a request to update your final grades with the 5% for the whole class, so you might notice a slight boost from that, for some of you it will bump you up a half letter grade, which might feel significant. Sorry for the inconvenience there, and thanks for pointing it out promptly.

Speaking to the grades, some of you will be pleased, others might be frustrated or upset by them. For those of you who are pleased with your marks, feel free to skip this next bit, although it's probably a helpful refresher as well.

As you are no doubt aware, we are increasingly raising the bar with the deliverables we expect as a reflection on what will be expected of you as a professional in the industry. These final capstone projects specifically were meant to be showcase pieces that demonstrated everything you have learned this semester, and were allotted significant time to accommodate them. Overall, while a few were really polished as a game demo, many of the projects were not complete to the standards expected at this time in the program.

For the grading, I wanted to anticipate and address your concerns up front, but feel free to follow up with me individually if you would like me to suggest some ways you could improve your projects moving forward to show more professionally.

The main places people lost marks on the assignments were the following:

1. Documents (Rule Page) and Deliverables (Builds) were not submitted. Presentation was an element of this assignment, as the goal was to present something ready for industry. This means something easily and obviously runnable, a video or playable build. You shouldn't expect someone to be digging through raw source code, projects that crash or won't run, or trying to interpret your results. Include clear instructions and reasonable hand-in of assets.

I tried to give you all the benefit of the doubt when I could though and creatively interpreted the rubric in places to give you marks for things that were hard to quantify, to reflect the work you did put in and the efforts made.

2. Lack of gameplay: Especially for Game Development, the assignment specifically stated :

"You should focus on gameplay mechanics, game balance, and creating interesting and engaging challenges for the player to face."

Many of you submitted interesting tech gizmos that had not yet transformed into an actual game, mechanic or set of challenges. This made it hard to interpret certain elements of the rubric related to gameplay, and ultimately impacted some of your marks. As I said, I tried to give you some marks to accommodate this, but many of the projects appear to be more of a tech demo then a final and polished game ready to playtest.

3. There was some confusion among some of you that sending in the proposal somehow superseded the assignment document, which was not the case. The proposal was for the system you were to be working in, but I was still expecting the gameplay elements outlined in the original assignment document and rubric. Sorry for the confusion this caused, but at the end of the day, the assignment and rubric are ultimately the goal, and I am as bound by the rubric and assignment as you are, probably more in fact. I tried to give some marks to accommodate the effort and potential of what such systems could become, but ultimately the goal was to build a working game demo and many people simply didn't present that.

4. Insufficient development: We had lots of lead time, extensions, and several dedicated work classes. I was available for feedback or support for most of that. Very few of you took me or the other instructors up on the offer to get help or feedback.

Ultimately, a part of my job is to evaluate where your projects are relative to where they need to be to be hitting the professional standards expected by the industry. I hope you take my feedback as it is intended: A helpful push in the right direction getting your work ready to present as professionals. I'm not trying to be contentious, and ultimately don't enjoy giving out grades I know you will not be

happy with, but the larger goal is to make sure you are prepared for the realities of a tough and competitive industry. I included Kyle and Chris in this email specifically as well as a second opinion if you think I am being overly harsh.

While several of you were very consistent and worked hard throughout the term, overall this was not the strongest semester as a group. Many of the assignments were full of complaints and excuses, and the work was overall often late, inconsistent and incomplete. While I know there are a multitude of reasons why this might be the case, it's hard to ignore in aggregate. While there was some strong effort at times and some cool designs, ultimately I would suggest many of you need to step up next semester in terms of communication and consistency. I'm not sure exactly the reasons, but am open to constructive feedback and suggestions for what could be helpful next semester to your success.

As of this time, the grades have been submitted and are out of my hands. I am happy to meet, chat or email with any of you to discuss your projects or strategies moving forward, however I'm unable at this point to make any additional changes to the grades. You are welcome to appeal them if you wish by pursuing a formal student appeal. You can find the link here and you have 5 days to start the process, which is basically before Tuesday of next week.

<https://www.rrc.ca/supports/complaints/student-appeal-guide/>

Moving forward:

Course Content ▾ Assessments ▾ Communication ▾ Resources ▾

Dropbox Folders

[View History](#)

Folder	Content
No Category	
Assignment 1- History of Games	
Due on Sep 5, 2025 11:59 PM	
Attachments	

Updates:

- December Safety, Health and Security [Update](#)
News Posted - Red River College
yesterday.at.11:34 AM
- "A2 - Individual Reflection" updated.
Your grade is: 11 / 12, 91.7 %, 4.6 / 5% of final grade
Grade Updated - DMMT-3012 (267107) Game Development 1
Thu.at.11:24 AM
- "A2 - Individual Reflection" Released.
Feedback Released - DMMT-3012 (267107) Game Development 1
Thu.at.11:24 AM
- "Final GD1 Capstone Project Hand In Dropbox" updated. Your grade is: 21 / 32, 65.6 %, 23 / 35% of final grade
Grade Updated - DMMT-3012 (267107) Game Development 1
Wed.at.11:33 AM

learn from those who come before you, and I hope you all reflect on this over the holidays. Team work and aligning the group outcomes will be critical to success of our GD4 game, and with that the term. Little cracks in team unity, people coming late or being overly negative, unresolved frustration or issues have a way of snowballing under pressure and it's important we are all working hard to resolve issues as efficiently and directly as possible to have the best chance of success moving forward.

I hope you all take this winter break to do some reflection on how we can all make the next semester go smoother, and what you need from each other, and from myself and the other instructors, to be able to feel like you are able to do your best work and succeed.

We tried several different formats for assignments this semester, and I would be curious which of them you preferred, and what worked the best/worst for you in terms of content delivery (live demo, lecture,

video, slides with notes, etc.), and if there are other topics you hoped we would touch on that we haven't yet.

I will have you (the programmers) for a full day one day a week next semester, for Modern Tech and Game Dev 2. Both courses are usually quite dependent on the needs of the GS4 project so if you have thoughts about what Unreal Modules would be useful to learn about, let me know sooner rather than later.

Some suggestions would be Behaviour Trees, Niagara, UI, Sequencer, Procedural Generation etc. I'm going to try to make the assignments and deliverables as clear as possible, so I'm happy to hear about what worked or didn't work for you this semester in terms of assignments and deliverables. At a high level, GD2 is usually AI, mechanics and gameplay testing, while Modern Tech is specific "modern" modules or specific topics. Think about which topic we will need to cover first to support your project.

Events:

Also, if you are still reading this, there is an event at NMM tonight you might be interested in.

Derek, Winson, Kade and Taq, June, Warren Peters and Eneme's event.

New Media Manitoba | 62 Albert Street | Thursday Dec 11th 530-730PM

About the Event

What goes into creating a vertical action-platformer built entirely around movement, momentum, and an ever-rising threat?

Join developers Derek, June, Kade, Tak, and Warren Peters from ENEME INC for a behind-the-scenes look at *Unsung Escape*. They will share how the game's core mechanics, including Energy Orbs, double-jumps, dashes, and traversal-focused level design, shaped a pressure-driven climb with no enemies and pure platforming.

This postmortem covers the team's creative process, technical challenges, and key lessons learned throughout development. Whether you are new to game creation or already shipping projects, this session offers practical insight into building polished movement-driven experiences.

<https://www.zeffy.com/en-CA/ticketing/unsung-escape-postmortem>

Derek may have reached out about this one. It will be a unique opportunity to hear from former students trying create and launch games, and the trials and tribulations that brings and a good chance to connect in a smaller setting. It's a bit last minute, but if you are around tonight it should be a good event.

Final Notes:

I also want to end on a more positive note by saying that I am excited to reset things are have a fresh start next year. We have a lot of exciting guests, industry folks, play testers and others already lined up to visit, so be prepared to be showing off your work shortly after returning in January.

I would love to arrange for a more formal showcase or demo day, pre grad show as well for you to get you in front of some industry folks, so lets work to having a working project as soon as possible so we can begin showing it off and getting feedback asap.

There has been a ton of momentum in the industry lately, with the announcement of ANOTHER 30k of funding for NMM and Ubisofts Initial Development Support Program (IDSP), as well as the opening of a new Game Development specific Co-working space run by NMM and Ubisoft.

<https://newmediamanitoba.com/gamebiz-lab/>

I'm sorry you were not able to make it to the first years showcase, but we were able to get a lot of interest generated and confirm a bunch of industry guests and speakers from that event, and I would love to host something like that for you as well in the future. There is also a large game jam planned for February, and I'm sure a ton more speakers and events to get involved in as well.

I'd be happy to chat with any of you about how you could continue to develop and even commercialize any of your projects post-grad/outside of school as well.

Anyways, lots of good stuff is coming in 2026 is the theme. I hope you all have a relaxing and fun holiday break, away from the stress and trials of school. Play some games and start thinking critically about what we need for GS4. Have a great holiday and I'll see you in January!

Sincerely,

Dylan